

Essential Insights: Week 1.2



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Module Overview

Understanding AI's Impact on Enterprise Value Chains

- AI is moving beyond isolated tools into core organisational workflows
- Generative AI is reshaping how organisations design and execute work
- The focus is shifting from task productivity to workflow transformation
- Value chains provide the best lens to understand enterprise-level impact
- This module explores how AI affects marketing, operations, finance and customer support

AI as a Value-Chain Transformer

From Task Automation to Structural Change

- Early AI adoption focused on automating individual tasks
- Generative AI influences entire workflows across departments
- It integrates analysis, creation, communication and execution
- Organisations can redesign how information flows between stages of work
- The result is faster coordination and more adaptive decision-making

Understanding the Enterprise Value Chain

How Organisations Create Value

- A value chain describes how inputs are converted into outcomes
- Includes analysis, planning, execution and customer interaction
- Traditional automation optimised individual activities
- Generative AI connects multiple stages of work simultaneously
- Impact becomes strategic when applied across the entire chain

Marketing Value Chain Transformation

From Linear Campaigns to Continuous Optimisation

- Traditional marketing followed sequential stages: research → strategy → creative → execution
- Teams worked in separate silos with multiple handoffs
- Generative AI enables rapid content generation and testing
- Campaign assets can be personalised for different audiences
- Marketing becomes a continuous optimisation process

Customer Support Transformation

Faster and More Consistent Customer Service

- Support processes involve issue intake, classification and response
- Agents often spend time searching information and drafting replies
- Generative AI summarises issues and suggests response drafts
- Knowledge from policies and documentation is synthesised quickly
- Agents maintain control while AI reduces administrative workload

Operations Workflow Transformation

Improving Planning and Coordination

- Operations rely on planning, monitoring and cross-team coordination
- Workflows often involve heavy documentation and manual communication
- Generative AI supports SOP generation and procedural updates
- It summarises operational alerts and suggests response actions
- Teams can respond to disruptions faster and more consistently

Finance Workflow Enhancement

From Reporting to Strategic Advisory

- Finance functions include forecasting, budgeting and reporting
- Significant effort goes into report preparation and documentation
- Generative AI converts financial data into clear narrative reports
- Variance explanations can be generated in plain language
- Finance professionals spend more time supporting strategic decisions

Workflow Compression & Cognitive Leverage

Transforming How Work Moves Across the Enterprise

- Organisations often struggle with slow handoffs and fragmented workflows
- Generative AI reduces delays by enabling tasks to happen in parallel
- Workflow compression shortens cycles and reduces unnecessary transitions
- Cognitive leverage scales expert-style thinking across teams
- Employees gain faster access to reasoning patterns and best-practice guidance

From Copilots to Digital Workers

Evolving from Task Assistance to Workflow Execution

- Copilots support individual tasks but rely on humans to drive progress
- Agentic systems operate around goals and maintain continuity over time
- Key capabilities: goal awareness, controlled autonomy, and persistence
- Humans shift from micromanaging tasks to supervising outcomes
- Used responsibly, digital workers scale execution and reduce operational friction